DEREK MICHAEL WRIGHT

Dear Hiring Manager,

Please accept my application for this position. I have a *BSc* in Biology from the *University of Regina*, a *MSc* in Agrobiotechnology from *Justus-Liebig-Universität Gießen (University of Giessen)* and have been employed at the *University of Saskatchewan* as a Research Assistant in the pulse crop breeding & genetics group working with lentils.

For the last 10 years I have been in charge of field trials for various lentil populations, including a diversity panel (LDP) and numerous inter-specific RIL populations, giving me an extensive knowledge of the phenotypic diversity within the *Lens* genus. In addition to overseeing our field trials, I have experience in wrangling very large data sets and performing complex statistical procedures such as PCA, GWAS and QTL analyses, etc. I am very comfortable working in R and have a passion for data visualization. I have created my own package called `gwaspr` specifically for visualizing GWAS data. In my most recent publications, NIR was used to estimate protein content and UAV imagery to model growth curves for the LDP across multi-environment trials and performing GWAS on novel traits derived from the analysis. In my previous work for the AGILE project at the UofS, I was part of a large experiment investigating phenology in the LDP across the major macroenvironments for cultivated lentils, modeling days to flower based on temperature and photoperiod. This was followed by an investigation with GWAS using a somewhat novel approach exploiting our large multi-environmental datasets. In my current work, I am part of a wheat-lentil project (ACTIVATE) investigating nitrogen use efficiency and investigating the interactions between these 2 crops. In addition, I am also wrangling and analyzing large seed imagery data sets to identify the casual genes for cotyledon color, seed coat color and patterning and have extensive experience dealing with data from highthroughput phenotyping systems.

I am confident that with my knowledge and experience in plant breeding and research, I will make me a good fit for this position. Thank you for your consideration, and I hope to hear from you soon.

REFERENCES

Dr. Kirstin Bett (Research Supervisor)
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Project Manager — University of Saskatchewan
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Dr. Rod Snowdon (MSc Supervisor)
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Dr. Harmeet Chawla (Professional Colleague)
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Skills

- Photography
- Biology &Genomics
- Data Analytics & Visualization
- The R Project

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